

American Pie -- Don McLean

From *American Pie* (1971). About 138 BPM for the band sections, est.

Bass: Harley Benton P/J, 5-string, passive. GP-5 only.

A warm early-70s folk-rock bass that follows the changes with melodic walk-ups. It gets more active and driving as the song builds.

Built from the song's overall sound. I haven't verified the exact bass rig on the record.

Fingers over the neck. P pickup dominant. Tone knob around 45%.

Module chain

NR -- Gate, always on.

THRE: 10.

Low.

PRE -- COMP (Ross), always on.

Sustain: 36, VOL: 58.

Even walk-ups.

DST -- Bass OD, on CTL.

Gain: 18, Blend: 20, VOL: 55, Bass: 52, Treble: 48.

A hint of hair for the bigger, driving later verses. Blend 20.

AMP/CAB -- NAM SnapTone, slot 51: CleanB15 (always on)

- Built from the `Ampeg B18 - Head DI - Bass Chan - Vol 2.5 (B-18N)` NAM and the Apg115 IR, combined into one snaptone.
- Real Ampeg B-18N fliptop (the B-15 preamp circuit), captured clean at volume 2.5, into the Apg115 B-15 cab IR.
- Early-70s studio bass: a B-15 miked in the room. Round and clean under the acoustic strum.
- Gain: 49, VOL: 80, Bass: 58, Middle: 52, Treble: 40
- Gain 49: a little under default. This part wants less push than the other CleanB15 patches.
- Bass 58: more low end.
- Middle 52: a touch more midrange.
- Treble 40: top end pulled back noticeably.
- VOL 80: the level Michael set for this snaptone in the 2026-10-02 VOL audit. Trim here if the patch jumps in level against your others.
- Same in both CTL states. AMP and CAB are off in the `.prst`, so nothing stacks on the capture. The N->S block calls slot 51 directly.

EQ -- Bass EQ 2, always on.

50Hz: +1, 120Hz: +2, 400Hz: 0, 800Hz: +1, 4.5kHz: -3, VOL: 52.

Warm with a touch of 800Hz so walk-ups read.

MOD -- off.

DLY -- off.

RVB -- off. Dry 70s rhythm section.

CTL footswitch

On CTL: DST (Bass OD, hint).

- **CTL off** -- Early verses. Warm, round, melodic. This is the resting state the patch loads into.
- **CTL on** -- The driving later verses and final choruses. A hint of push.

Engage once the band really digs in, around the "Jack be nimble" section, and hold it through the big choruses.